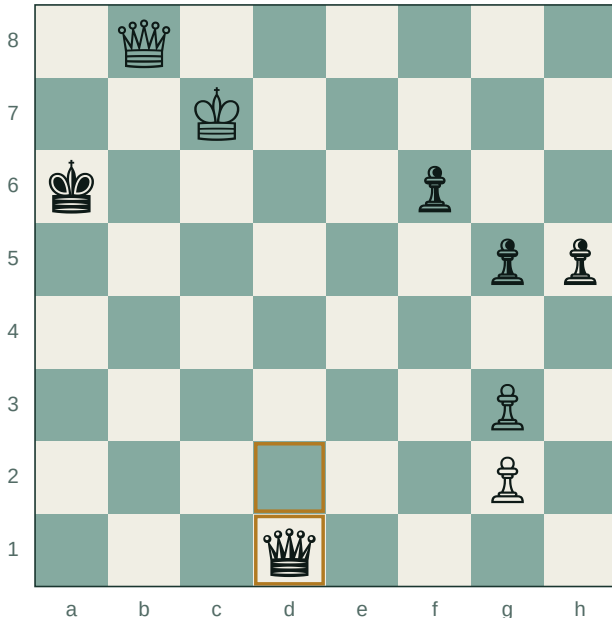


# Queen-ending tactics: White, move 54

Queen-ending tactics

## White to move



Previous move: 53...d1=Q. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

## WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

### 54. Qb6#

**54.Qb6#** Mate: queen on b6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a6. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

## CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on b6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

## HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on a6. Geometrically undefended: queen on d1. Check for tactical protection.